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Ilala Lodge Hotel, Victoria Falls

The perfect location from which to explore Africa's adventure capital

Ilala Lodge Hotel is a family-run hotel that offers luxury and comfort in the heart of Victoria Falls, Zimbabwe. Nestled in attractive gardens, the well-appointed hotel is a mere eight-minute walk from Victoria Falls, one of the Seven Natural Wonders of the World.

The hotel is ideally located in the hustle and bustle of town, within walking distance of all historical sites, restaurants and activities in Victoria Falls. Offering warm and welcoming true African hospitality, our friendly and attentive staff will ensure that your visit is perfect in every way.

The award-winning Cassia Restaurant at Ilala Lodge Hotel is famous for its delicious gourmet cuisine and attracts guests worldwide. Diners can see the spray and hear the sounds of Victoria Falls, locally known as the 'Smoke That Thunders', while they enjoy the al-fresco dining under the starry African skies that the Cassia Restaurant offers. Wild animals, such as warthog and impala, often graze on the hotel lawns and entertain guests during mealtime.

Located on the Zimbabwean side of the mighty Zambezi River, Ilala Lodge Hotel is geographically the closest hotel to the magnificent Victoria Falls and is easily accessible to the town centre. Explore the lush wilderness surrounding the town on a game drive, surf the rapids on a Zambezi River white-water rafting expedition, get your heart racing as you bungee jump off the Victoria Falls Bridge, or view the Falls from the exhilarating angle of Devil's Pools on the edge of the plunging water. You can also enjoy a legendary Zimbabwean sunset from the comfort of the elegant Ra-Ikane river cruisers, part of the Ilala Lodge Hotel group.

Accommodation

All Rooms

Victoria Falls Accommodation

The well-appointed rooms at Ilala Lodge Hotel are spacious and offer the ultimate in comfort and luxury.

Each of the 73 luxury rooms are designed to create a feeling of privacy here in Victoria Falls. The rooms on the upper tier open out onto a private balcony, while the lower floor rooms open onto the lush manicured gardens where you can watch the warthogs graze from the hotel lawn. You may even be lucky enough to have a visit from an elephant.

Guests can choose rooms in the Deluxe Wing, the Garden Wing or the Pool Wing. The Deluxe Wing and the Pool Wing boast splendid views of the mesmerizing spray from Victoria Falls as well as the spectacular gardens that Ilala Lodge Hotel is famous for. The Garden Wing gives guests access to the lush and flourishing lawns where the animals visit.

The teak furnishings in all the rooms are made from local Zimbabwean railway sleepers, enhancing the African ambience and laid-back atmosphere of the hotel. All the rooms in the hotel have high-quality cotton linens and luxurious pillows for ultimate comfort. Take your pick of a room here and indulge in the world-class service at Ilala Lodge Hotel.

Classic Rooms

The Twin Classic Rooms at Ilala Lodge Hotel are complete with two comfortable $\frac{3}{4}$ beds set within an expansive space, and an en-suite bathroom with a separate shower. The King Classic Rooms are ideal for couples, as they have one cosy king-size bed and an en-suite bathroom with a separate shower.

Our King and Twin Classic Room options are decorated with railway teak furnishings, allowing you to experience the grandeur of days gone by. With air conditioning units installed in all Classic Rooms, guests are treated to a cool sanctuary from the warm Victoria Falls climate.

Sliding doors open onto a luscious garden, offering a gateway to nature and the opportunity to see warthog, elephant, bushbuck, hippo and other wildlife grazing on the lawns. Make yourself at home by unpacking your belongings and relax and unwind in the comfort of your room.

Amenities

- Air-conditioning
- Mini Bar (with Complimentary Initial Stocking)
- Complimentary Toiletries
- In-room Dining
- Writing Desk
- Free Wi-Fi
- Overhead Fans
- Satellite Television
- Laundry Service
- Tea and Coffee Facilities
- Hairdryers
- Digital Safe

Classic Suites

The Classic Suites are located on the top floor and have private balconies that offer magnificent views overlooking the hotel's gorgeous grounds and Victoria Falls itself. The suites have an ultra-comfortable King-size bed and an additional $\frac{3}{4}$ bed is neatly tucked around the corner in a private section of the room.

For families of more than three, the Classic Suite **is connected** to a Classic Twin bedroom via an interleading door. The interconnecting room is equipped with a private bathroom and balcony overlooking views of the mist that rises from Victoria Falls.

Amenities

- Private Patio Facing Victoria Falls
- Additional $\frac{3}{4}$ bed
- Interconnecting room options available
- Large Bathtub
- Double Vanity Basins
- Air-conditioning
- Complimentary Toiletries
- Mini-Bar (with Complimentary Initial Stocking)
- In-room Dining
- Writing Desk
- Free Wi-Fi
- Overhead Fans
- Satellite Television
- Laundry Service
- Tea and Coffee Facilities
- Hairdryers
- Digital Safe

Deluxe Rooms

Situated in the stylish West Wing, the Deluxe Rooms at Ilala Lodge Hotel ooze old-world charm and sophistication. Ideal for couples, solo travellers and families alike, the Deluxe Rooms feature either twin or double configurations.

The Twin Deluxe Rooms have two three-quarter beds and an en-suite bathroom with a walk-in shower. The **King** Deluxe Rooms have one King-size bed and an en-suite bathroom with a walk-in shower. All bathrooms have double vanities.

All Deluxe rooms are complete with a private patio overlooking the hotel's lush gardens that merge with the wildlife National park. From the comfort of their balcony, guests can enjoy wildlife sightings as well as the stunning sunrise through the mist that rises over the Victoria Falls.

Amenities

- Double Vanity Basins
- Air-conditioning
- Complimentary Toiletries
- Mini-Bar (with Complimentary Initial Stocking)
- In-room Dining
- Writing Desk
- Free Wi-Fi
- Overhead Fans
- Satellite Television
- Laundry Service
- Tea and Coffee Facilities
- Hairdryers
- Digital Safe

Executive Suites

The Executive Suites in our West Wing have a lounge and a separate bedroom. The bedroom contains a luxurious King-size bed with an en-suite bathroom containing a walk-in shower, his & her basins and a separate bathtub. Adjoined to the bedroom is a spacious private lounge offering a homely space in which to unwind and soak in the delicate pieces of local artwork and decor within the room.

Guests of the Executive Suites have a private patio that opens off the bedroom and wraps around to the private lounge, here guests may enjoy the magnificent sunrise views over the mighty Victoria Falls.

Amenities

- Private Lounge
- Private Patio Facing Victoria Falls
- Large Bathtub
- Double Vanity Basins
- Air-conditioning
- Complimentary Toiletries
- Mini-Bar (with Complimentary Initial Stocking)
- In-room Dining
- Writing Desk
- Free Wi-Fi
- Overhead Fans
- Satellite Television
- Laundry Service
- Tea and Coffee Facilities
- Hairdryers
- Digital Safe

Strathearn Suite

Our most luxurious suite, the Strathearn Suite, is named after hotel founder, Strathearn Brown, who opened Ilala Lodge Hotel in 1989. Fashioned with modern and sophisticated décor, the Strathearn Suite delivers a tranquil haven of relaxation and luxury.

The suite comes complete with a private lounge, kitchenette, en-suite bathroom with double vanity basins, walk-in shower and an indulgent bathtub. There is a private balcony, where guests can enjoy a large spa bath while soaking in world-class views of the spray rising above the mighty Victoria Falls waterfall.

Guests will also receive in-room continental breakfasts, welcome sparkling wine, a complimentary river cruise (subject to availability). Private in-room dining is also available on request.

In addition to offering an ideal romantic retreat, the suite can also be transformed into a comfortable and spacious family villa, via a pair of interleading doors into a secondary suite and deluxe guest room.

Amenities

- Private Patio Facing Victoria Falls
- Private Kitchen
- Spa Bath on Balcony
- Private Spacious Lounge
- Interconnecting room options available
- Large Bathtub
- Double Vanity Basins
- Air-conditioning
- Complimentary Toiletries
- Mini-Bar (with Complimentary Stocking)
- In-room Dining
- Writing Desk
- Free Wi-Fi
- Overhead Fans
- Satellite Television
- Laundry Service
- Tea and Coffee Facilities
- Hairdryers
- Digital Safe

Rates

[INSERT RATE TABLES]

Important notes

Check in: 14:00 hrs

Check out: 11:00 hrs

Rooms will be held until 18:00 hrs. After which, rooms will automatically be released unless hotel is informed of late arrivals.

Guests are required to present a voucher where relevant upon arrival. This can be in printed or digital format. Should agent no longer issue vouchers, written confirmation will be required

Additional request or extras must be indicated on booking request by Travel Agent/Tour Operator. Where this is not the case, guests will be asked to settle direct.

The hotel will invoice at the negotiated nett rate, inclusive of 15% VAT and 2% Government Tourism Levy.

Children's rate has been indicated on the rates sheets

Children aged 3 years and under will be accommodated free of charge when sharing a room with their parents or other paying guests

All rooms accommodate a maximum of 2 guests (except for the Classic Suites at Ilala Lodge Hotel) or whereby an infant child can be accommodated in a cot.

The hotel reserves the right to amend the above rates in-line with any government statutory increases

FIT Booking & Payment Policy

A 20% non-refundable deposit must be made within 30 days from the date of placing the booking

The balance must be made on or before 60 days prior to travel date

If the booking is within 60 days of travel full payment is required

FIT Cancellation fees

Cancellations made within 30 days or less of arrival – 100% cancellation fee

60 – 30 days – 50% cancellation fee

More than 60 days – 20% non-refundable deposit retained

The above percentages are based on the total value of the amount shown on invoice

Groups Booking & Payment Policy

Applicable to groups of 16 or more paying guests

Confirmation must be made within 30 days from the date of placing the booking

A 20% non-refundable deposit must be made within 30 days from the date of placing the booking

The balance must be made on or before 60 days prior to travel date

If the booking is within 60 days of travel full payment is required

For every 16 full paying pax in a booking the 17th person is accommodated on a comp B&B basis

Groups Cancellation Fees

Cancellations made within 30 days or less of arrival – 100% cancellation fee

60 – 30 days – 50% cancellation fee

More than 60 days – 20% non-refundable deposit retained

The above percentages are based on the total value of the amount shown on invoice

Groups of 20+ Rooms

Applicable to groups of 20+ rooms booked

180 days prior to arrival - update on sales + 20% non-refundable deposit needs to be made to continue to hold the space.

120 days prior to arrival - release period

90 days prior to arrival - initial rooming list to be provided

60 days prior to arrival - final rooming list to be provided

Groups 20+ Rooms Cancellation Fees

91 - 180 days - 20% non-refundable deposit retained

61 - 90 days - 50% cancellation fees

31 - 60 days - 75% cancellation fees

0 - 30 days - 100% cancellation fees

Please note that we do not have an attrition policy. Cancellations will be applicable on individual number of pax booked within a group.

Specials

[Specials Table]

Terms & Conditions:

- Special offer valid for new bookings only for guests staying between 1st November – 28 February 2026 (Excluding 22nd December 2025 – 3rd January 2026).
- Special offer valid for all nationalities.
- 2 and 3 night value adds as detailed on the 2025 rates still apply.
- A 20% non-refundable deposit must be made within 30 days from the date of placing the booking, if the booking is within 60 days of travel full payment is required.
- Includes 15% VAT and 2% Government Tourism Levy.
- The hotel reserves the right to amend the above rates in line with any government statutory increases.
- Rooms will be held until 18:00 hrs, after which rooms will automatically be released unless the hotel is informed of late arrivals.

Cancellation fees:

- More than 60 days – no charge
- 60 – 30 days – 50%
- Less than 30 days – 100% cancellation fee
- The above percentages are based on the total value of the amount shown on invoice

Bookings made within the 60 days will be held provisionally for 48 hours. Full payment must be made during this time in order to secure booking.

Rooms will be held until 18:00 hrs. After which, rooms will automatically be released unless hotel is informed of late arrivals. Ilala Lodge Hotel reserves the right to amend the above rates in line with any government statutory increases.

Facilities

Our Facilities

Ilala Lodge Hotel offers an exceptional range of facilities designed to enhance your stay and make every moment memorable. The hotel's conferencing and event facilities provide a spacious and private setting for small meetings and executive events. The Poolside Bar invites guests to unwind in a charming setting with stunning views, while the two swimming pools offer the perfect spot to cool off. Additionally, the Tours and Activities Desk ensures guests can effortlessly explore the wonders of Victoria Falls.

Poolside Bar

Open 10h00 to 22h00 daily. Located alongside the duo of swimming pools is an idyllic space in which to unwind and enjoy an afternoon cocktail. Enjoy the warm and welcoming teak cocktail bar, made from locally sourced railway tracks from previous eras. An array of comfortable seating and sun loungers offer a relaxing space in which to enjoy a sundowner overlooking the Victoria Falls National Park and the mist rising from the Victoria Falls waterfall.

Swimming Pools

The hotel offers guests a choice of two swimming pools: a larger pool with a shallow end and gentle slope and a plunge pool located on a lower deck overlooking the hotel gardens, National Park and spray from Victoria Falls. The pools are framed with timber decks complete with pool loungers, umbrellas and cabana day beds. Both swimming options are conveniently located next to the hotel's pool bar as well as a modern and relaxing pool side lounge equipped with open plan seating, writing desk, games table, books, USB chargers and plug points.

Tours & Activities Desk

With so much to see and do in the Victoria Falls and surrounding area, the tours and activities desk offers an invaluable information asset to help guests plan their stay and book their activities inhouse. A friendly and knowledgeable team can assist in booking an array of activities as well as transfers and river cruises.

Conferencing & Event Facilities

Spacious and privately appointed, the hotel's conferencing room offers an expansive meeting place in which to host conferences, events, webinars, gatherings and more. Conferencing facilities include fully-serviced amenities, tea and coffee facilities, free Wi-Fi, projector screens and USB connection points and is suitable for a maximum of 30 guests.

Beauty Spa

Unwind and relax, in the hotel's rejuvenating spa. The spa offerings include a variety of aromatherapy treatments inspired by the natural surrounds, soothing massages and beauty treatments such as manicures and pedicures.

Dining

Welcome to the Cassia Restaurant

The Cassia Restaurant, located at Ilala Lodge Hotel, offers an unmatched menu and an extensive wine list featuring carefully selected wines from South Africa's top vineyards. The calming and tranquil ambience sets the stage for a truly unforgettable dining experience at one of the finest Victoria Falls restaurants, within earshot of the gentle rumble of Victoria Falls. Don't miss the opportunity to indulge in exceptional cuisine amidst the natural beauty of this iconic destination.

The Cassia Restaurant delivers an unmatched menu, paired with an extensive wine list comprised of carefully selected wines from South Africa's top vineyards. The calming and tranquil ambience is further complemented by the gentle rumble of Victoria Falls in the background. A truly unforgettable dining experience not to be missed.

In January 2022 we announced the re-naming of our highly acclaimed restaurant, previously known as the Palm Restaurant. The new name – The Cassia Restaurant – derives from a duo of bold and beautiful Cassia Fistula trees poised in front of the hotel, facing the direction of the mighty Victoria Falls. The trees – also known as an Indian Laburnum or Golden Shower trees – are a common feature by which the restaurant is fondly recognised and remembered.

In full bloom, the trees become decorated with a golden crown. Along each branch blossom beautiful flower clusters attached to a central stem – known as pendulous racemes. Hundreds of plump golden pendulums hang from the branches of the tall trees, casting a sheltering shadow over the restaurant's al fresco dining area.

The Cassia Restaurant serves an unparalleled dining experience in Victoria Falls, where guests can enjoy a delicious à la carte menu for breakfast, lunch and dinner. The idyllic location makes it one of the most popular Victoria Falls restaurants, a favourite among visitors with its close proximity to Victoria Falls. Guests can start their day with a delicious continental buffet and order off the breakfast menu while enjoying the morning sunshine.

The popular lunch menu can be enjoyed under the shade of the Cassia Trees or while relaxing nearby the pool-side bar. The lunch menu includes a wide range of delicious options from succulent signature burgers to lighter lunchtime bites. Compliment your meal with a selection of local and imported beers, wine, gins, cocktails and more available.

For a gourmet al-fresco dining experience, the Cassia Restaurant offers a calming evening ambience where guests can enjoy dinner under starry African skies while listening to the rumble of the Falls in the background. An extensive range of South Africa's best wines is also available to accompany your meal.

The calming ambience of the restaurant, superb cuisine and attentive world-class service allows for an unforgettable dining experience at the Cassia Restaurant. If you're looking for Victoria Falls restaurants, we look forward to welcoming you to this elegant eatery.

Restaurant Hours

Breakfast 06.30 – 10.00

Lunch 12.00 – 14.00

Dinner 18.30 – 21.30

View our Menus

Breakfast

Lunch

Dinner

TESTIMONIALS

[Insert Testimonials]

Location

The Hotel

The Hotel

Ilala Lodge Hotel offers elegant accommodation and is one of the best places to stay in Victoria Falls. The ambience of this family-run, luxury hotel celebrates a unique African history and the inviting décor of the stylish rooms provides the ultimate in modern comfort. The Victoria Falls National Park borders the front of the property and, as such, wild animals often graze on the hotel lawns. Warthogs, in particular, are common visitors and they are sure to delight and entertain you. You might even be lucky enough to witness a herd of elephants feasting on the trees while you relax on your private balcony.

Restaurant

The award-winning Cassia Restaurant is famous for its gourmet cuisine and is rated 'Excellent' on TripAdvisor. Guests can see the spray and hear the thunder from the world-renowned Victoria Falls waterfall while enjoying al-fresco dining. The restaurant offers a delicious breakfast buffet, lunch and al fresco evening dining under the starry African sky. The Cassia Restaurant's unmatched menu is complete with an extensive wine list comprised of carefully selected wines from South Africa's top vineyards. The calming and tranquil ambience is further complimented by the gentle rumble of Victoria Falls in the background.

Our Facilities

Ilala Lodge Hotel offers an exceptional range of facilities designed to enhance your stay and make every moment memorable. The hotel's conferencing and event facilities provide a spacious and private setting, fully equipped with modern amenities to accommodate up to 30 guests for meetings and executive events. For relaxation, the Poolside Bar invites guests to unwind in a charming setting with stunning views, while the two swimming pools offer a respite from the heat, both adjacent to a well-appointed lounge area. Additionally, the Tours and Activities Desk ensures guests can effortlessly explore the wonders of Victoria Falls, with a dedicated team ready to assist in planning and booking a variety of activities.

Victoria Falls

As a holiday destination, Victoria Falls is simply the ultimate all-round experience. The scenery, the wildlife, the activities and the culture and history combine to offer a fantastic adventure. Ilala Lodge Hotel is centrally located, offering guests an ideal place to begin their journey. In fact, the hotel is only 936 steps from the mighty Victoria Falls – we counted!

Victoria Falls, located on the border between Zimbabwe and Zambia, has some of the most astounding views of any natural World Wonder – take a look at our series of Victoria Falls sunrises to get inspired!. The massive sheet of falling water is mesmerizing and awe-inspiring, as is the view down the chasm itself. The natural rainforest on the Zimbabwean side of the Falls is a unique habitat to over 400 plant species, numerous birds species and small antelope and primates. The nearby Victoria Falls National Park, as well as the towns of Victoria Falls and Livingstone, offers additional activities. Choose from nature-based activities, cultural trips or the exhilarating options of bungee jumping and white-water rafting. The park is teeming with all the magnificent African wildlife, including elephant, lion, buffalo, leopard and rhino.

Victoria Falls Zimbabwe View Points

1 Devil's Cataract & Livingstone's Statue (70m high)

The most Western edge of the falls overlooking Devil's Cataract so named because the local tribes used to perform sacrificial ceremonies from the Cataract island.

2 The "Chain Walk"

A set of stairs leading down into the gorge, the only viewpoint below the top level of the gorge. Allow for excellent views down the length of the gorge, towards Main Falls.

3 — 5 Devil's Cataract & Main Falls

All afford great views looking towards Devil's Cataract and New Falls where you can see the river starting to erode the next fault line. In thousands of years, this will become the new Victoria Falls.

6 Approaching Main Falls, from this long viewpoint, one can look back towards Devil's Cataract, Cataract Island and then Main Falls.

7 Looking west towards Devil's Cataract, you can see it in full length, with views of the gorge and the river far below. Best seen early in the day as this is one of the few viewpoints with a rainbow in the morning.

8 Main Falls (93m high)

The best views of Main Falls with beautiful rainbows in the afternoon. However, when the river is in flood, little can be seen due to torrents of spray, with a peak flow rate of 700 000 cubic metres per minute. Moving on from Viewpoint 8, you will enter the true 'Rainforest': Large trees in constantly damp soil, this amazing area is one of the only places on Earth to receive 'rain' 24 hours a day, 365 days a year.

9 — 11 Main Falls

These Viewpoints will take you out of the rainforests and can be very wet with spray in the high-water seasons.

12 Livingstone Island

Provides wet and intermittent views of Livingstone Island and Rainbow Falls in high water. It is the island on the opposite side of the gorge from which Livingstone is said to have first seen the falls.

13 Horseshoe Falls (95m high)

Aptly named, the geography of the falls creates a horseshoe-shape on the eastern side of Livingstone Island. This section has the lowest volume of water and is therefore the first to dry up during the dry season.

14 Rainbow Falls (108m high)

This is the highest section of Victoria Falls at 108m. As the name suggests, beautiful rainbows can be enjoyed in the afternoon and whilst walking on to the next viewpoint.

15 Danger Point

So named as it leads along the cliff edge next to the Rainbow Falls to the most eastern edge of Zimbabwe. This is where the turbulent water from the falls exits and continues downriver. From this point, you can see the Eastern Cataract on the Zambian side and if looking down into the gorge, you will see the 'Boiling Pot' and Rapid number 1, where the commercial White-Water Rafting trips start.

16 Victoria Falls Bridge

This last viewpoint is away from the falls following the gorge south, bringing you to view the famous Victoria Falls bridge, which links the countries Zimbabwe and Zambia. Keep a lookout for adrenaline seekers taking the 111-meter plug that is the Victoria Falls Bridge Bungee Jump.

When to visit Victoria Falls?

Victoria Falls can be experienced differently at different times of the year. From April to July, the Falls are full and spectacular, as they are at their peak flow. They create an impressive wall of water and visitors are sure to get wet as they walk through the dense rainforest from the spray. Photos are a bit trickier to get from the ground at this time of year. For the best game viewing, visit the Falls from late August to the end of December. During this drier period, the wildlife is far

more visible in the bush; the water flow of the Falls diminishes and the rocky cliff can be seen better.

What you need to take with you:

- Your ID and a credit card or cash for the entry fee
- International ID \$58USD
- SADC ID \$35USD
- Zimbabwean ID \$7USD
- A plastic bag from Ilala Lodge Hotel to protect your valuables
- Tennis shoes for the walk
- A hat and sunscreen

History of Victoria Falls

The history of Victoria Falls is a fascinating one based primarily on the monumental discovery of the Falls by Dr. David Livingstone in 1855. When he and his exploratory team first encountered the 'Smoke that Thunders', he saw '...scenes so lovely they must have been gazed upon by angels in their flight.' Livingstone's discovery and the history surrounding it intrigue many Victoria Falls visitors. Tours of this UNESCO World Heritage site give great insight into this history. Ilala Lodge Hotel has compiled a book that tells the story in detail and is available at the hotel.

Victoria Falls Bridge

The Victoria Falls Bridge was built in 1905 to link what are now Zimbabwe and Zambia. The bridge was the vision of Cecil John Rhodes, who wanted 'the spray of the Falls on the train carriages'. The impressive bridge was constructed from steel and the arch spans 156.50 metres, with a height of 128 metres above the valley floor. Apart from carrying the usual cars, trains and foot traffic, it also hosts the world-famous 111-metre Shearwater Bungee Jump. A railway museum near the Victoria Falls is a good source of information for railway enthusiasts.

For more information about all the exciting things to do in the area, be sure to visit our Activities Page and our Victoria Falls blog.

Map

Location

Ilala Lodge Hotel is geographically the closest hotel to Victoria Falls. It is only an 8-minute walk, or 936 steps away, from the hotel lobby to the entry gate at the Falls. Conveniently situated just before the Victoria Falls Bridge on the A8, commonly known as the Mosi-Oa-Tunya Road, this hotel is not only central to the iconic Falls but also serves as an ideal accommodation choice if you seek proximity to the town's hustle and bustle. For those in search of hotels near Victoria Falls Zimbabwe, Ilala Lodge Hotel offers both convenience and a strategic location for exploring the wonders of this renowned destination.

The greatest thing about Victoria Falls is that it is the hub of Southern Africa and is just a short distance away from so many popular attractions. Day trips to Zambia in order to experience the Falls from the other side can be arranged at Ilala Lodge Hotel's front desk. A day trip to Chobe National Park, Botswana, which is 80km from Victoria Falls, is wildly popular. The Chobe River is famous for its magnificent herds of elephant, bountiful wildlife and its variety of bird populations. Hwange National Park is only 100km and a day trip to view the abundant wildlife at one of Zimbabwe's world-renowned parks is just a few hours away. All this can be arranged at the Activities Desk at Ilala Lodge Hotel.

The Victoria Falls Airport is 25km from Ilala Lodge Hotel and the journey takes approximately 25 minutes. The hotel can arrange transfers to and from the airport. This new international airport allows easy access from major cities including Johannesburg, Cape Town, Harare, Nairobi and Windhoek.

Activities

Victoria Falls Activities

Ilala Lodge Hotel is perfectly placed to make the most of your Victoria Falls holiday.

Known as Africa's adventure capital, Victoria Falls has a lot to offer visitors. From high-adrenaline activities like bungee jumping off the Victoria Falls Bridge and white-water rafting down the Zambezi River, to more sedate pastimes like Ra-Ikane river cruises, Zambezi riverside dining or High Tea experiences – there is something for everyone. Check out some options below and contact our Activities office here for help with arranging your perfect itinerary for a trip of a lifetime!

High Tea Experience

Experience unparalleled refinement at the Palm River Hotel's enchanting High Tea on the Zambezi River. Under the dappled shade of indigenous trees, and amidst the tranquillity of the flowing river, savour an exquisite experience at the Palm River Hotel. Advanced reservations are essential. Email fnb@palmriverhotel.com

Riverside Dining Experience

Experience authentic African-style barbeque dining beside the Zambezi River at our sister hotel, Palm River Hotel. Enjoy a 3-course dinner featuring locally sourced barbeque options, such as crocodile and kudu steaks grilled al fresco. Delight in the serene riverside setting with lanterns and a starlit canopy. For more information, contact fnb@palmriverhotel.com.

Ra-Ikane River Cruise

Relive the historical journey taken by David Livingstone by exploring the mighty Zambezi River aboard the Ra-Ikane. The boats boast old world charm, setting a romantic and intimate scene whilst you sit back, relax and take in the surrounding views. With a maximum of 16 seats available, the Ra-Ikane offers a unique vantage point for viewing birdlife and wildlife up-close on the islands along the river.

River Activities

A tour of the mighty 'Smoke That Thunders', is an unforgettable experience, worthy of any Bucket List. Embark upon a leisurely 10 minute stroll from Ilala Lodge Hotel to enjoy the Falls at your own pace, or simply visit the Ilala Lodge Hotel Activity Centre to arrange a guided tour. The team will be sure to put you in touch with only the best and most experienced tour guides.

Adrenaline Activities

The town of Victoria Falls is the undisputed adventure capital of Africa. To get your heart racing in the best possible way, try out the 111m Bungee Jump off the world-famous Victoria Falls Bridge – one of the most popular activities in Zimbabwe. Otherwise, opt for the daring Devil's Pool infinity pool, the gut-rending Gorge Swing, the adrenaline-pumping Zip Line across the Batoka Gorge or the legendary Flying Fox.

Scenic Flights

Viewing the spectacular Victoria Falls from the air is one of the most breath-taking and exhilarating activities in Africa. By far the most popular option is the "Flight of Angels" helicopter trip over the Falls. However, guests can also enjoy 22-minute and 30-minute helicopter flights. Another option is a slightly more thrilling microlight flight over Victoria Falls.

Day Trips

Victoria Falls is located on the border of Zambia and Zimbabwe, is mere hour's drive from the border with Botswana, and is only 1 hour's drive from the Hwange National Park. This convenient location renders it the perfect destination for a two incredible day-trips: the Chobe Day Trip and the Hwange Day Trip. On these excursions, enjoy game viewing, cultural tours and more.

Game Viewing Activities

The Victoria Falls National Park and the Zambezi National Park boast a vast array of wildlife, including elephant, impala, kudu, leopard, lion and buffalo. Visit the Activity Centre to arrange either a 3-hour game drives in the morning or afternoon, a 4-hour game drive including a 3-course dinner, or a full day trip including a game-viewing cruise, lunch and a game drive.

Cultural Activities

Immerse yourself in a world of Victoria Falls culture. Choose from a range of half and full-day village tours, enjoy a vibrant dinner and drum show or experience a burst of local food with a lunch or dining experience. Find out more from our in-house Activities Office.

Gallery

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About

Our Story

About

The history of Ilala Lodge Hotel is an interesting one that ties a Zimbabwean family's background and business to the property that houses the popular and beautiful hotel today.

In 1989, the site, which was originally the Sprayview Restaurant, was offered to the then owners of the crocodile farm, Strath Brown and his partner, Rob Gee. Along with Strath's wife Beryl, they chose to open a boutique hotel that had 16 bedrooms; at that time, the number of rooms and the hotel rating dictated the price of beer in hotel bars and restaurants. Ironically, the original size of Ilala Lodge Hotel was based on this criterion!

In October 1989, the ground was officially broken and construction was underway. Their architect, Richard Beattie, and their interior designer, Thelma Newmarch, worked tirelessly with the builder, Biffen, to create an inviting atmosphere that was the foundation for the success that Ilala Lodge Hotel still enjoys. Strath and his son Keith were personally involved in the actual building of the hotel, thatching the roof themselves. Hand selected gum poles and thatching grass from the family farm in Darwendale were used in the original structure.

Beryl Brown was an avid and talented gardener, and established the appealing and attractive gardens and surrounds that have delighted guests for years. The unique Indian Laburnums, also known as the 'Golden Tree', are part of Beryl's contribution, and literally light up the front of the hotel when they are in bloom. Thelma suggested the name 'Ilala Lodge' after the Ilala palms that grow in the area. 'Ilala' is also the Ndebele word for 'lie down'.

In 1991, the opening ceremony was a resounding success with the local Chief, a highly respected member of the community of Victoria Falls, presiding over the show. As tradition allows, the Chief blessed the hotel, signifying what was to be a great start for Ilala Lodge Hotel. In April 1991, the first guests to stay at the hotel were family friends from Darwendale.

In 1994, Strathearn's daughter, Laura Brown (General Manager) oversaw the addition of 18 new rooms doubling the capacity of the hotel to 34 rooms. By 2015 this grew to a further 56 rooms. In 2018, a new round of renovations expanded the hotel to a total of 73 rooms and includes a selection of Classic and Deluxe Rooms and Suites.

Today, Strath's sons, Andrew and Jim – along with their families – are involved in making Ilala Lodge Hotel the success it has evolved into.

FAQs

Frequently Asked Questions

1. DO YOU OFFER AIRPORT TRANSFERS TO ILALA LODGE HOTEL?

Yes, we do.

Pick up and drop off to Victoria Falls Airport – US\$21 per person each way (approximately 30 minutes drive)

Pick up and drop off to Livingstone Airport (Zambia) – US\$50 per person each way (approximately 1 hour)

Pick up and drop off to Kasane Airport (Botswana) – US\$69 per person each way (approximately 1.5 – 2 hours)

2. HOW FAR IS ILALA LODGE HOTEL FROM THE VICTORIA FALLS?

It is a gentle 8 – 10 minute walk, which is only about 936 steps, from the front door of the hotel. Alternatively, we can arrange a taxi for those less mobile.

3. DO I NEED TO RENT A CAR IN VICTORIA FALLS?

It is not necessary to rent a car in Victoria Falls. We provide airport transfers, inter-hotel transfers and all activities have transfers to and from the hotel included in the cost.

4. DO YOU HAVE WI-FI AT THE HOTEL?

Yes, we do have free Wi-Fi access.

5. DO YOU HOST WEDDINGS AT ILALA LODGE HOTEL?

Regretably, we do not host weddings at our hotel premises. However, we always welcome accommodation-only bookings for weddings held locally.

6. DO YOU HAVE MOSQUITO NETS OVER THE BEDS?

Our Classic Suites and Executive Suites will have 4-poster mosquito netting over each bed. Our Classic Rooms and Deluxe Rooms do not. However, there are air conditioning units as well as extra mosquito spray and cream available in each room.

7. SHOULD I TAKE MALARIA MEDICATION BEFORE TRAVELLING TO VICTORIA FALLS?

Although Victoria Falls is not considered a high-risk malarial area, it is advisable to seek advice from your doctor before travelling to the area to be 100% safe.

8. ARE THERE FRIDGES IN THE ROOMS?

Each room is equipped with a minibar fridge.

9. DOES YOUR RESTAURANT CATER FOR VEGANS / KOSHER / VEGETARIANS / HALAAL?

Yes, we can cater for specific nutritional needs. However, please inform the hotel of your requirements a few weeks in advance so the Chef can ensure we have the correct foods in stock for your arrival. Our general menu does offer Vegetarian options.

10. ARE THERE ATMS NEAR THE HOTEL?

We recommend you bring small denomination USD cash to Victoria Falls to pay for shops, entrance into the Falls, curios markets etc.

12. WHAT CURRENCIES DO YOU ACCEPT AT THE HOTEL?

We accept US Dollars, Zimbabwe Dollars, Euros, Pounds Sterling and South African Rands.

13. WHAT CREDIT CARDS DO YOU ACCEPT AT THE HOTEL?

Visa and Mastercard are accepted at the hotel.

14. IS IT POSSIBLE TO ADD AN EXTRA BED TO A CLASSIC ROOM?

Unfortunately, we cannot add an extra bed to a Classic Room. Our Classic Suites each have a King size bed plus an extra $\frac{3}{4}$ bed. Alternatively, for families with children, we can recommend inter-leading Classic or Deluxe Rooms, or the Strathearn Family villa.

15. DO YOU HAVE FAMILY ROOMS?

There are a number of family options with interleading rooms. Please contact us to find out more.

16. DO YOU OFFER BABYSITTING SERVICES?

A babysitter can be arranged on request. Please advise the hotel at least 24hrs before.

17. HOW CLOSE IS THE HOTEL TO THE CENTRE OF VICTORIA FALLS CITY?

Our hotel is situated in the heart of the Victoria Falls city centre and we are within walking distance of both the city and the Victoria Falls waterfall.

18. HOW MANY ROOMS DO YOU HAVE?

We currently have 73 rooms.

19. DO YOU HAVE HAIRDRYERS IN THE ROOMS?

All rooms have hairdryers available.

20. WHAT TYPE OF PLUG POINTS DO YOU HAVE AT THE HOTEL AND SHOULD I BRING AN ADAPTOR?

We mostly have Type D (round) and Type G (square) plugpoints. There are universal plug points and USB ports available in all rooms.

21. DO YOU STILL HAVE COVID RESTRICTIONS IN PLACE TO ENTER ZIMBABWE VIA LAND BORDERS OR AIR?

As of June 2023, all COVID-19 restrictions in Zimbabwe have officially been lifted. This means that guests are no longer required to present COVID-19 vaccination certificates upon arrival in the country. In addition, pre-departure testing for unvaccinated travellers is also no longer a requirement. This is applicable to guests entering the country via both land borders as well as international airports.

22. IS THERE A DECLARATION FORM I NEED TO FILL OUT ON ENTRY INTO ZIMBABWE?

Yes, there is. Stay ahead of the queues by completing the Zimbabwean Immigration Declaration form **online** before you fly. Find the form [here](#).

23. WHEN IS THE BEST TIME TO VISIT VICTORIA FALLS?

From high water seasons with hot temperatures to the low water season offering exceptional visibility of the Falls and cooler days, Victoria Falls is a year-round destination. To find out which season best suits your preferences, get in touch with our dedicated travel specialist.

24. WHAT DO I NEED TO PACK FOR MY TRIP TO VICTORIA FALLS?

Light and cool clothing are generally recommended for warmer days, but layers may also be advisable for cooler evenings. Don't forget your hat, sunglasses and sunscreen.

Ilala Cares

The Palm Hospitality Group Foundation

Who We Are

The Palm Hospitality Group (PHG) Foundation is a local initiative made up of passionate employees of the Ilala Lodge Hotel and Palm River Hotel, who work together to bring about meaningful and practical support for our local community of Victoria Falls. The Palm Hospitality Foundation was formed in 2022 and brings together the efforts of both hotels to form a dynamic, like-minded committee dedicated to preserving our wonderful town of Victoria Falls.

What We Do

The PHG Foundation aids our local community by promoting responsible tourism projects such as environmental preservation, recycling, wildlife protection, local fundraisers and various other initiatives that support the community and preserve the rich cultural heritage of Victoria Falls town.

“Do your little bit of good where you are, it's those little bits of good put together that overwhelm the world.” - Desmond Tutu

Inspired by this quote, we endeavour to support, contribute and care for our staff, environment and community as best we can, wherever we can, whenever we can.

Wildlife Conservation

The PHG Foundation supports the Victoria Falls Anti-Poaching Unit (VFAPU) – a non-profit organization dedicated to the conservation of local wildlife and natural resources in Victoria Falls. Our monthly donations play a crucial part in local wildlife protection and rehabilitation.

Humanitarian Support

The PHG Foundation works with several community projects, non-government organizations, schools and hospitals to provide support and much-needed care within the local community.

Environmental Preservation

Every first Friday of the month, our committee takes to streets, carparks and public areas as part of a community clean up. Our teams have also installed over 20 ‘baboon-proof’ waste bins throughout the rainforest to help maintain and preserve the surrounding tourist attractions.

Sustainable Waste Management Initiative

Among many achievements, the PHG Foundation proudly introduced a sustainable waste management initiative, presented to the Greenline Africa Trust and the Victoria Falls Recycling Project. The initiative includes various events and projects that endeavour to better the future of green development and sustainable tourism in Victoria Falls.

Internally, our policies include:

- A Waste Management policy to reduce waste first, separating it into Glass, Plastic, Paper and Aluminium for various recycling purposes
- Glass water bottles for drinking water offered at The Cassia Restaurant and Bar to reduce our plastic waste
- Guests are also asked to indicate whether their linen in the room requires changing, thus reducing water usage in the laundry
- Grey water used in composting and gardens

In the wider environment of Victoria Falls, our green policies include:

- Being an active member of the Victoria Falls Recycling Project and participant in monthly National Clean Up Days
- Greenline Africa: Ilala Lodge guests have the option to contribute any amount at the end of their stay. This is used for a variety of projects including Water for Elephants, Sponsor a Gogo/Child, The Ele-Bee Fence, Smallholder horticulture programme alongside Agritex and many more
- Active participant in the clearing of the noxious weed, Lantana Camara from around the Zambezi River area

How You Can Help!

If you would like to support the PHG Foundation, we kindly request a voluntary contribution of as little as \$5.00 – that can be added to your bill upon check out. All donations go directly towards the PHG Foundation fund to continue giving back to the Victoria Falls community and the conservation of our local wildlife!

OUR LATEST ENDEAVOURS

At Ilala Lodge Hotel, we have a real community spirit and enjoy doing our bit of good wherever we can.

Here are a few of our recent initiatives:

Blog

Press & News

Press & News

Stay up to date with latest announcements, media features and press releases from Ilala Lodge Hotel.

Plan Your Trip

Whether it's your first time to Africa or whether you're a seasoned traveller, our team are here to help compile a personalised travel itinerary and provide you with all the information you need for an unforgettable holiday. Our team can help offer a wealth of interesting, informative and helpful advice to ensure your stay in Victoria Falls is perfect in every way.

[INSERT FORM]

Contact

Contact

[INSERT FORM]

DIRECT BOOKINGS:

onlinereservations@ilalalodge.com

+263 719 384 920

Chat to us on Whatsapp

AGENT RESERVATIONS:

reservations@ilalalodge.co.zw

+263 83 2844737/8/9

+263 83 2842650

+263 712 401 814

Agent Login

HOTEL RECEPTION & RESTAURANT:

guestrelations@ilalalodge.co.zw

+263 83 2844737/8/9

Chat to us on Whatsapp